urge towards synthesis, derived essentially from the Indian philosophic outlook, was the dominant feature of Indian cultural, and even racial, development. Each incursion of foreign elements was a challenge to this culture, but it was met successfully by a new synthesis and a process of absorption. This was also a process of rejuvenation and new blooms of culture arose out of it, the background and essential basis, however, remaining much the same.

The Earliest Records, Scripture and Mythology

Before the discovery of the Indus Valley civilization, the Vedas were supposed to be the earliest records we possess of Indian culture. There was much dispute about the chronology of **the** Vedic period, European scholars usually giving later dates and Indian scholars much earlier ones. It was curious, this desire **on the** part of Indians to go as far back as possible and thus enhance **the** importance of our ancient culture. Professor Winternitz thinks that the beginnings of Vedic literature go back to 2,000

B.C., or even 2,500 **B.C.** This brings us very near the Mohenjo-daro period.

The usual date accepted by most scholars to-day for the hymns